Ownership Transfers and Eviction Filing Rates: Event Study

Philly Evictions Project

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1 Overview

This document reports an event study of eviction filing rates around ownership transfers in Philadelphia rental properties. The central question: **do eviction rates change when a property changes hands, and does it depend on who buys it?**

We construct a panel centered on each transfer event, tracking filing rates from 3 years before to 5 years after the sale. We estimate building fixed effects models that identify the effect from within-building variation over time, controlling for year shocks.

Key findings:

1. Eviction filing rates increase sharply after ownership transfers, rising by approximately 0.8 percentage points (relative to a baseline of ~3%) within two years of sale.
2. The effect is driven entirely by **corporate buyers** — individual-to-individual transfers show no increase or a slight decline in filings.
3. The effect is **not limited to small properties** — it appears across all building sizes, with the largest point estimates for 10–19 and 20+ unit buildings.
4. Larger portfolio buyers (10+ properties) show the steepest increases.
5. **Selection concern**: Corporate transfers substantially increase the probability that a property obtains a rental license (+9 pp at $t + 1$) or appears in rental listings (+8 pp at $t + 0$). This suggests corporate buyers are bringing formerly owner-occupied properties onto the rental market, mechanically expanding the population at risk for eviction.
6. **Acquirer filing history matters**: Using pre-acquisition filing rates on the acquirer's other properties (years before the transfer), high-filer portfolio acquirers show the largest post-transfer increase; low-filer portfolio acquirers show a moderate increase; non-filers and single-purchase acquirers show little change or a decline.

2 Data Construction

2.1 Transfer events

Transfer events come from the Philadelphia Real Estate Transfer Tax (RTT) records (`rtt_clean`), which log every deed transfer with buyer (grantee), seller (grantor), sale price, and document type.

Processing steps:

- Multiple transfers of the same PID in the same year are collapsed to one observation, keeping the transfer with the highest `total_consideration`.
- **Sheriff's deeds** (foreclosures) are flagged via `document_type`. Approximately 10% of all RTT records are sheriff's deeds. These are predominantly received by banks, servicers, and government-sponsored enterprises (Fannie Mae, Freddie Mac, HUD) — entities that temporarily hold title after foreclosure, not active landlords.

2.2 Owner linkage

Buyer names are standardized and linked via `r/build-owner-linkage.R`:

- **Corporate entities** are classified using `business_regex` (matching LLC, INC, CORP, TRUST, BANK, and ~40 other business keywords). Legal entity suffixes (LLC, INC, CORP, LP, LTD, CO, COMPANY) are stripped to group variants (e.g., "EMC MORTGAGE CORPORATION" and "EMC MORTGAGE LLC" map to the same owner group).
- **Individual names** are *not* grouped across transfers — matching "SMITH ROBERT" across properties without address verification would create false merges. For 10+ unit buildings, 97% of top-evicting transfers are corporate, so this primarily affects small single-family properties where portfolio analysis is less relevant.
- **Portfolio size** is computed from non-sheriff acquisitions only, so that Fannie Mae's 1,200 foreclosure takeovers do not inflate its portfolio bin. Bins: Single-purchase, 2–4, 5–9, 10+, and Sheriff-only.

2.3 Event panel

For each transfer, we construct an event-time window $t \in \{-3, \dots, +5\}$ years relative to the sale year. We merge building-level outcomes from `bldg_panel_blp`:

- **Filing rate**: num_filings/total_units (contemporaneous, not the EB-smoothed pre-COVID rate)
- **Violations**, **complaints**, **rent** as secondary outcomes
- **Rental flags**: `rental_from_license`, `rental_from_altos`, `rental_from_evict`, `ever_rental_any_year_ever`

Sample: 1,471,948 building × event-time observations in the full baseline regression (after singleton removal). Coverage increases from 27% at $t = -3$ to 38% at $t = +5$, reflecting the panel's forward expansion. All regressions restrict to pre-COVID observations (calendar year $\leq$ 2019).

2.4 Sample descriptives

Table 1: Transfer sample descriptives by buyer type (at t=0)

Buyer Type	N transfers	Mean units	Mean filing rate	Mean violations	Median price	% Sheriff
Individual	403,900	1.3	0.0281	0.37	98,000	4.3
Corporate	109,454	2.0	0.0454	0.70	45,000	30.7

Corporate buyers acquire buildings with higher filing rates and more violations, pay lower median prices, and are much more likely to acquire via sheriff's deed (25% vs. 4% for individuals).

3 Specification

The baseline event study estimates:

$$\text{FilingRate}_{it} = \sum_{k \neq -1} \beta_k \cdot \mathbf{1}[\text{EventTime}_{it} = k] + \alpha_i + \gamma_t + \varepsilon_{it}$$

where i indexes buildings (PIDs), t indexes calendar years, and EventTime $k \in \{-3, -2, 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ relative to the transfer year (with $k = -1$ as the omitted reference period). α_i are building fixed effects and γ_t are year fixed effects. Standard errors are clustered at the PID level.

Specifications:

Spec	Sample	Fixed Effects
(1) Full	All buildings	PID + Year
(2) 2+ units	Buildings with 2+ units	PID + Year
(3) 5+ units	Buildings with 5+ units	PID + Year
(4) 2+ units, pre-transfer rental	2+ units with pre-transfer rental evidence	PID + Year
(5) 5+ units, pre-transfer rental	5+ units with pre-transfer rental evidence	PID + Year

The building FE absorb time-invariant building characteristics (size, location, quality). The progressive sample restrictions address key identification concerns: **2+ units** excludes single-family homes where a single filing produces a mechanically large filing rate; **pre-transfer rental** restricts to buildings that had rental evidence (rental license, Altos/Apartments.com listing, or eviction filing) in any year *before* the transfer. This is critical: 21% of transfer-events involve properties that first appear as rentals only *after* the sale (potential owner-occupied-to-rental conversions). Using "ever rental" (pre or post) would contaminate the sample with these conversions, where filing rate increases may be mechanical rather than behavioral. The pre-transfer restriction ensures we study properties that were already operating as rentals.

For **overlapping event windows** (49% of PIDs have multiple transfers), we stack all transfer events. Single-transfer-only is a robustness check.

4 Baseline Results

4.1 Raw means

Table 3: Raw outcome means by event time

event_time	mean_filing_rate	mean_filings	n	mean_violations
-3	0.03356	0.060	156,521	0
-2	0.03407	0.060	154,825	0
-1	0.04073	0.066	155,153	0
0	0.03343	0.059	162,425	0
1	0.04822	0.077	168,682	0
2	0.05532	0.087	171,614	0
3	0.05425	0.087	171,111	0
4	0.05281	0.085	169,420	0
5	0.05161	0.081	168,462	0

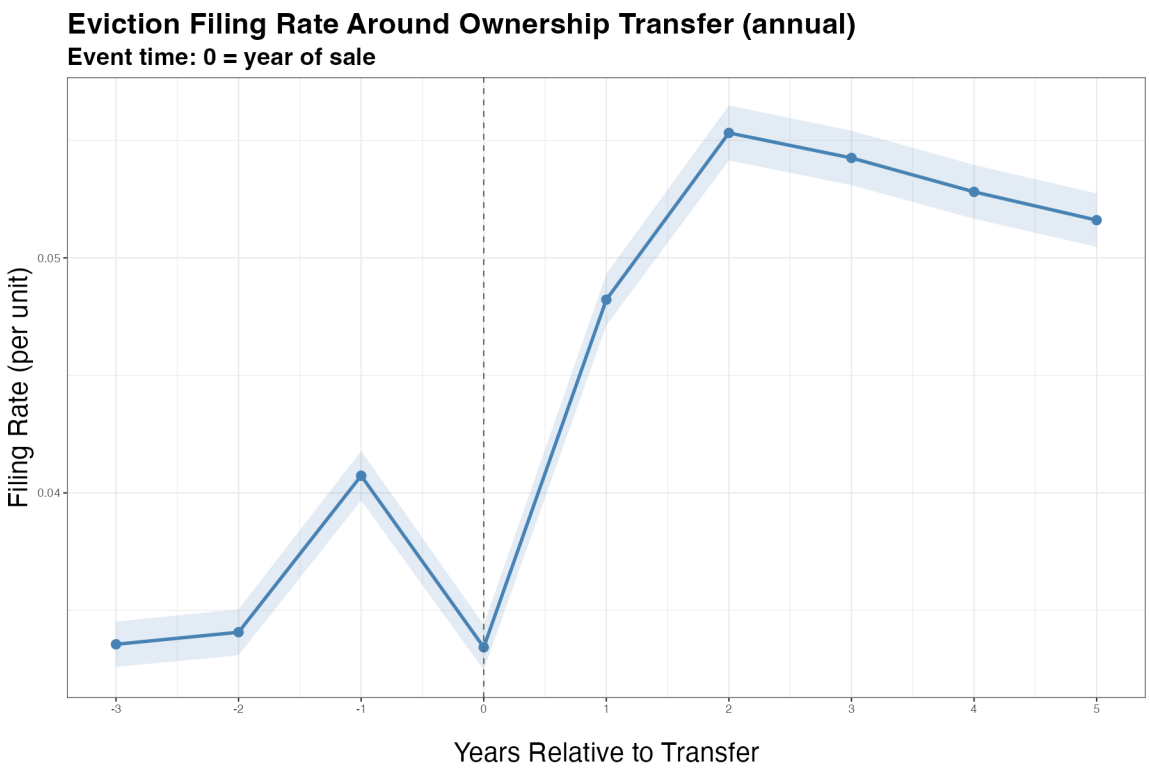

Figure 1: Mean filing rate by event time (full sample). Shaded ribbon shows 95% CI.

The raw means show filing rates at approximately 3.2% in the pre-period ($t = -3, -2$), rising to 3.8% at $t = -1$, dipping to 2.9% at $t = 0$ (year of sale), and then jumping to 4.0–4.6% in the post-period. The dip at $t = 0$ likely reflects a brief transition period where the building is changing hands.

Pre-trend concern: The jump from $t = -2$ (3.2%) to $t = -1$ (3.8%) is notable. Filing rates are *rising* into the transfer year. This could reflect sellers filing more evictions to clear out tenants before sale, or buildings with rising eviction pressure being selected into transfer. The regression's building FE control for the level of each building's filing rate, but the *trend* remains a concern for causal interpretation.

4.2 Regression estimates

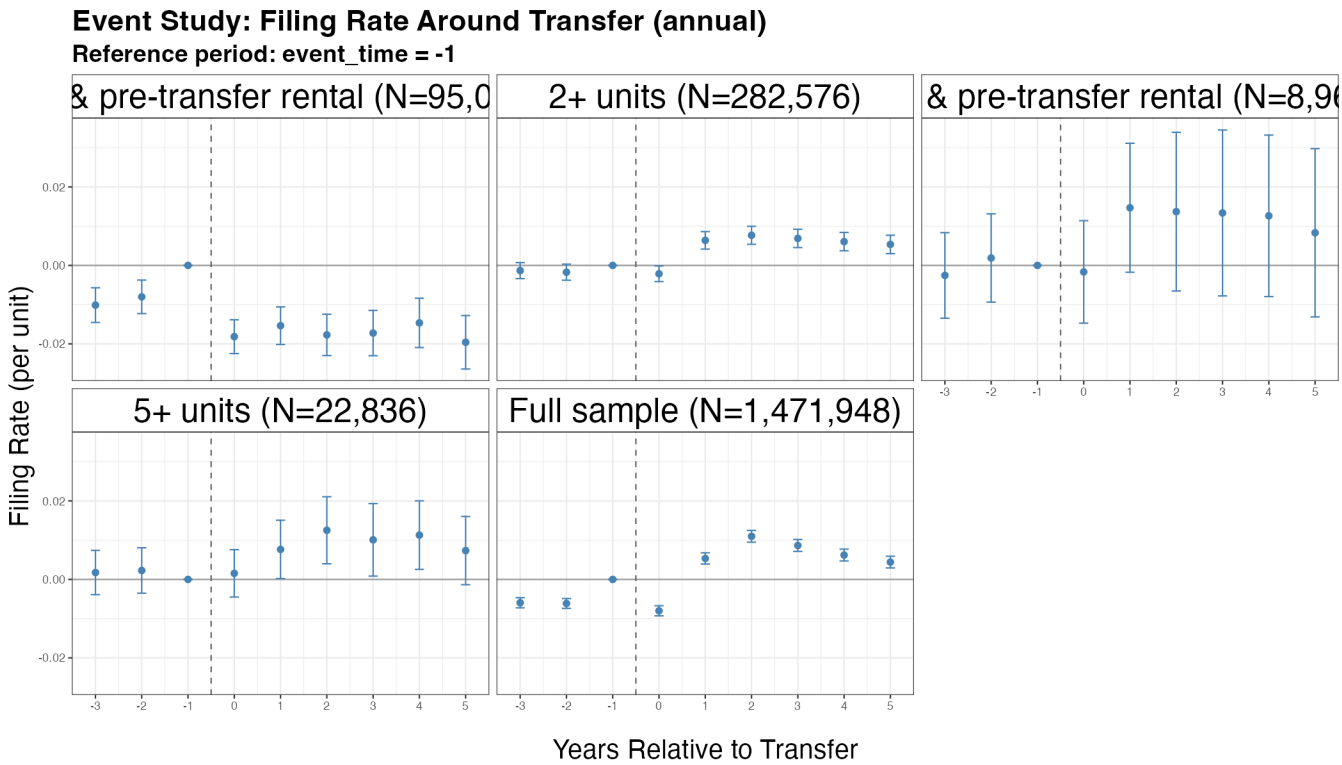

Figure 2: Event study coefficients: filing rate around ownership transfer. Reference period is t=-1.

	filing_rate				
Sample	All buildings	2+ unit buildings	5+ unit buildings	2+ units, pre-transfer rental	5+ units, pre-transfer rental
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
event_time = -3	-0.0059***	-0.0013	0.0018	-0.0101***	-0.0026
	(0.0007)	(0.0010)	(0.0029)	(0.0023)	(0.0056)
event_time = -2	-0.0061***	-0.0017*	0.0023	-0.0080***	0.0019
	(0.0006)	(0.0010)	(0.0030)	(0.0022)	(0.0057)
event_time = 0	-0.0080***	-0.0021**	0.0015	-0.0182***	-0.0017
	(0.0007)	(0.0010)	(0.0031)	(0.0022)	(0.0067)
event_time = 1	0.0053***	0.0064***	0.0076**	-0.0154***	0.0147*
	(0.0007)	(0.0011)	(0.0038)	(0.0024)	(0.0084)
event_time = 2	0.0110***	0.0077***	0.0125***	-0.0177***	0.0137
	(0.0008)	(0.0012)	(0.0044)	(0.0027)	(0.0103)
event_time = 3	0.0086***	0.0069***	0.0101**	-0.0172***	0.0134
	(0.0008)	(0.0012)	(0.0047)	(0.0029)	(0.0108)
event_time = 4	0.0062***	0.0061***	0.0113**	-0.0146***	0.0126
	(0.0008)	(0.0012)	(0.0045)	(0.0032)	(0.0105)
event_time = 5	0.0044***	0.0054***	0.0073*	-0.0196***	0.0083
	(0.0008)	(0.0012)	(0.0044)	(0.0035)	(0.0109)
Observations	1,471,948	282,576	22,836	95,050	8,967
R^2	0.22449	0.29525	0.61240	0.34011	0.62353
Within R^2	0.00096	0.00072	0.00135	0.00106	0.00150
PID fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
year fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Full sample (Spec 1): Filing rates increase post-transfer, sustained through $t+5$. Pre-period coefficients at $t-3$ and $t-2$ are negative (relative to $t=-1$), consistent with an upward pre-trend

as discussed above.

2+ units (Spec 2): Excluding single-unit properties (predominantly owner-occupied) produces a cleaner sample where filing rate changes are more interpretable as landlord behavior rather than rental market entry.

5+ units (Spec 3): Point estimates are larger but less precisely estimated given the smaller sample. Pre-trends are flatter, which is reassuring.

Pre-transfer rentals (Specs 4–5): Restricting to buildings with rental evidence *before* the transfer addresses the key selection concern: corporate transfers may bring formerly owner-occupied properties onto the rental market, mechanically increasing filing rates. The pre-transfer restriction excludes the 21% of transfer-events where the property first appears as a rental only after the sale. The **5+ unit, pre-transfer rental** subsample is our most defensible specification — established rentals where filing rate increases cannot be explained by rental market entry.

5 Selection Concern: Rental Market Entry

A central concern is that corporate transfers may bring formerly owner-occupied properties onto the rental market, mechanically increasing the population at risk for eviction filings. We test this directly by using rental license and Altos listing indicators as outcomes. **All rental entry regressions restrict to 2+ unit buildings and pre-COVID years.**

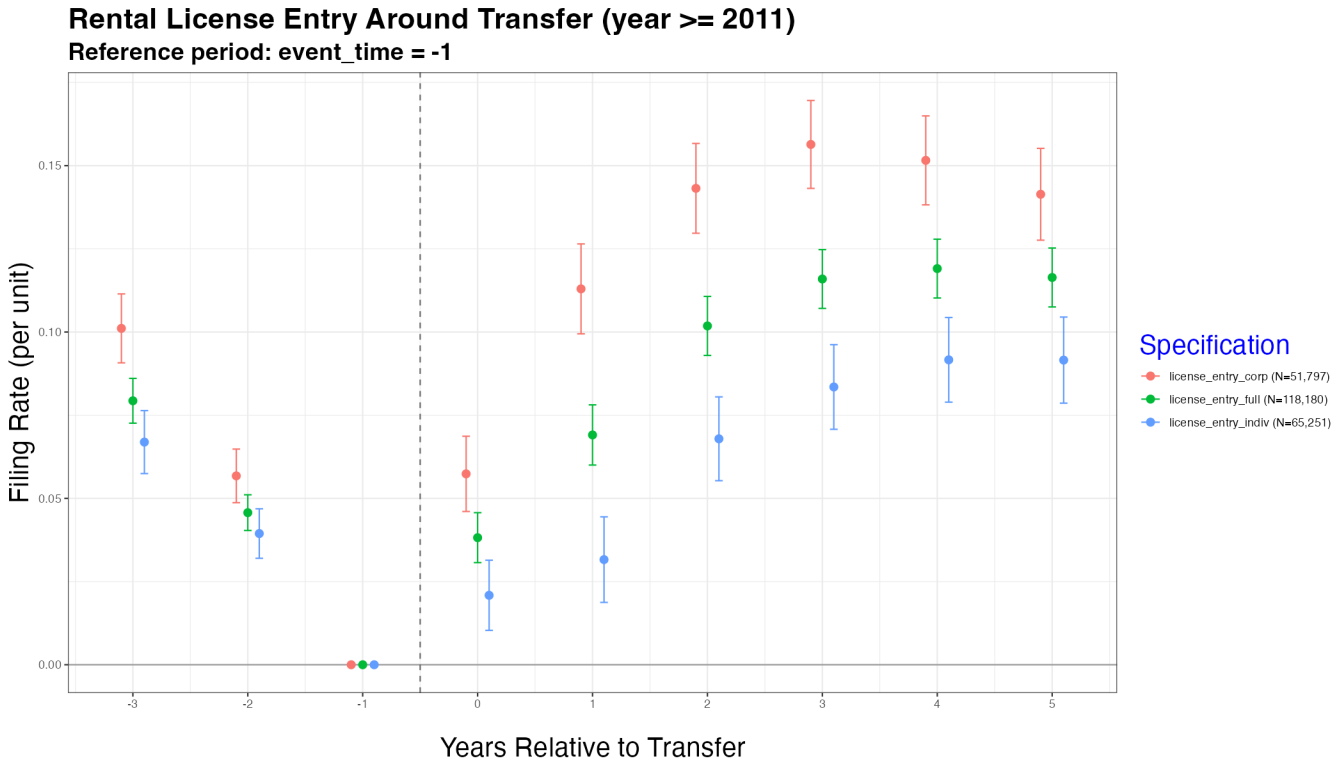

Figure 3: P(rental license) around transfer, by buyer type. Corporate buyers show a massive jump in rental licensing probability.

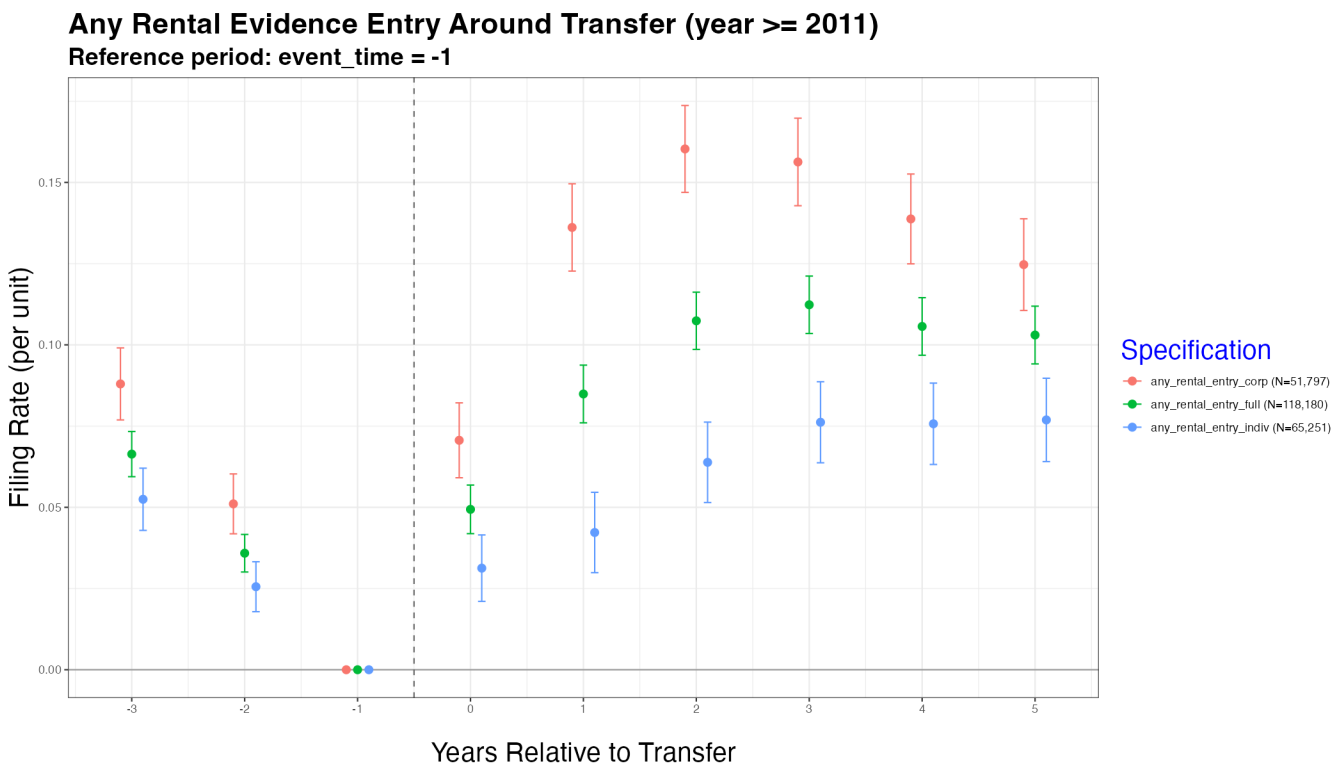

Figure 4: P(any rental evidence) around transfer, by buyer type.

Table 4: Rental market entry coefficients at key event times (relative to t=-1)

Specification	t-2	t=0	t+1	t+3
altos_entry_full	0.005	0.053	0.074	0.048
any_rental_entry_corp	0.051	0.071	0.136	0.156
any_rental_entry_full	0.036	0.049	0.085	0.112
any_rental_entry_indiv	0.026	0.031	0.042	0.076
license_entry_corp	0.057	0.057	0.113	0.156
license_entry_full	0.046	0.038	0.069	0.116
license_entry_indiv	0.039	0.021	0.032	0.083

Key findings:

- **Corporate buyers** increase P(rental license) by +8.9 pp at $t = 0$ and +16.8 pp at $t + 1$ (relative to $t = -1$). P(Altos listing) jumps by +7.7 pp at $t = 0$.
- **Individual buyers** show a slight *decline* in rental licensing at $t = 0$ (-3.3 pp), recovering by $t + 3$.
- The rental entry effect is large and highly significant. This is strong evidence that corporate transfers are converting owner-occupied properties to rentals.

Implication: The full-sample eviction increase after corporate transfers partly reflects the mechanical effect of new rentals entering the market. The **known rental 5+ unit** specification (Section 4) addresses this by restricting to properties already in the rental market.

Note: rental license coverage begins around 2013 in the Philadelphia data. All rental entry regressions are restricted to year $\geq$ 2011. Altos (Apartments.com) listing data is available from 2006.

6 Heterogeneity by Buyer Type

All heterogeneity and robustness analyses restrict the sample to **buildings with 2+ units**, excluding single-family homes where a single eviction filing produces a mechanically large filing rate and where most properties are owner-occupied (not at risk for landlord-tenant filings). All regressions use pre-COVID observations only (calendar year $\leq$ 2019).

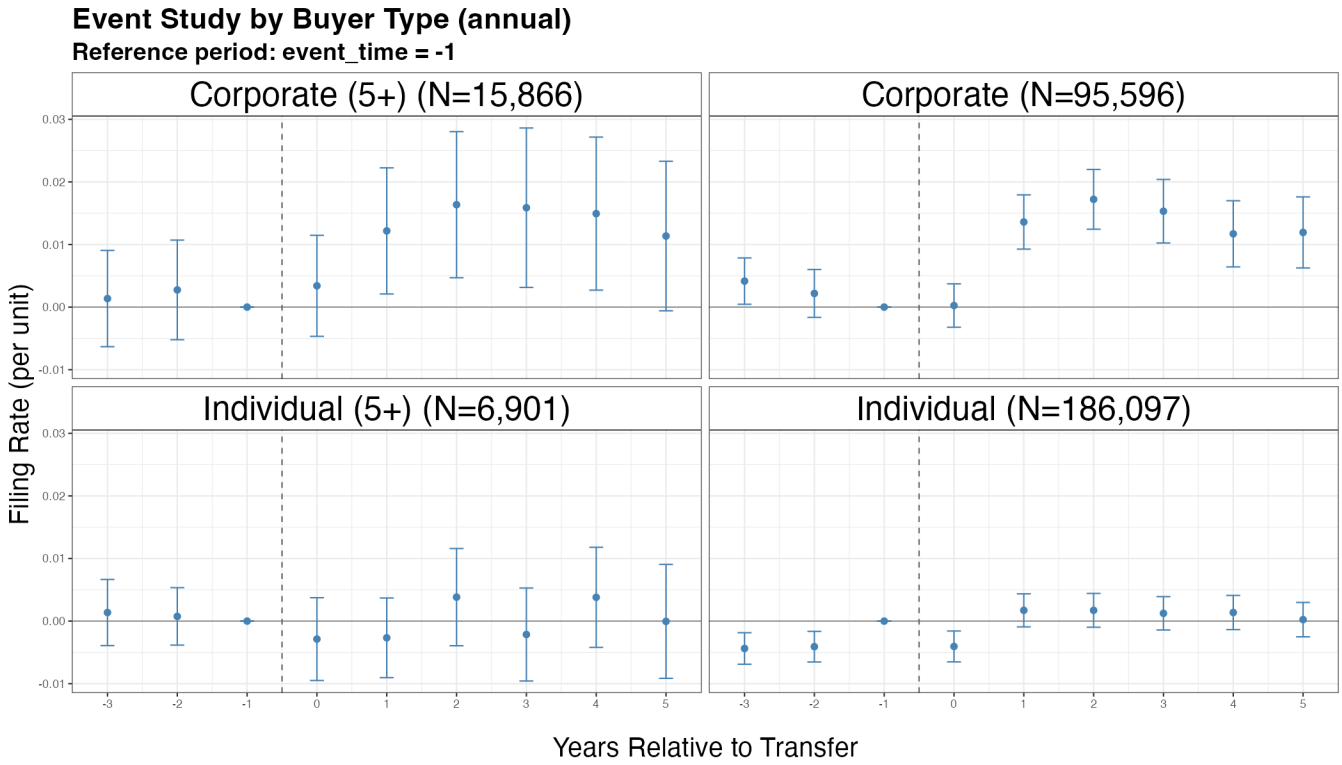

Figure 5: Event study by buyer type (split-sample, 2+ units). Corporate buyers show a sharp post-transfer increase; individual buyers show a slight decline.

The buyer type split reveals the central finding:

- **Corporate buyers**: Filing rates jump sharply post-transfer, with sustained increases through the post period. Pre-trends are essentially flat.
- **Individual buyers**: Filing rates show no post-transfer increase or a slight decline.

The contrast is stark. The aggregate post-transfer increase in evictions is entirely driven by corporate acquisitions.

	filing_rate			
Buyer type	Corporate	Individual	Corp (5+)	Indiv (5+)
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
event_time = -3	0.0042**	-0.0044***	0.0014	0.0014
	(0.0019)	(0.0013)	(0.0039)	(0.0027)
event_time = -2	0.0022	-0.0041***	0.0027	0.0008
	(0.0019)	(0.0012)	(0.0041)	(0.0023)
event_time = 0	0.0003	-0.0040***	0.0034	-0.0029
	(0.0018)	(0.0013)	(0.0041)	(0.0034)
event_time = 1	0.0136***	0.0017	0.0122**	-0.0027
	(0.0022)	(0.0013)	(0.0051)	(0.0032)
event_time = 2	0.0172***	0.0017	0.0164***	0.0038
	(0.0024)	(0.0014)	(0.0060)	(0.0040)
event_time = 3	0.0153***	0.0012	0.0159**	-0.0021
	(0.0026)	(0.0014)	(0.0065)	(0.0038)
event_time = 4	0.0117***	0.0014	0.0149**	0.0038
	(0.0027)	(0.0014)	(0.0062)	(0.0041)
event_time = 5	0.0119***	0.0002	0.0114*	-4.38×10^{-5}
	(0.0029)	(0.0014)	(0.0061)	(0.0046)
Observations	95,596	186,097	15,866	6,901
R^2	0.37493	0.25218	0.62506	0.46003
Within R^2	0.00137	0.00033	0.00204	0.00166
PID fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓
year fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓

6.1 Pre-transfer balance

Table 5: Pre-transfer balance by buyer type

buyer_type	mean_filing_rate	mean_violations	mean_units	n
Corporate	0.04082	0.49	2.0	257610
Individual	0.03021	0.34	1.3	911086

Buildings acquired by corporate buyers have slightly higher pre-transfer filing rates (0.038 vs. 0.034), more violations, lower rents, and more units. The event study's building FE absorb these level differences, identifying the effect from within-building changes.

7 Heterogeneity by Acquirer Filing Rate

We classify acquirers by their **pre-acquisition temporal filing rate** on the acquirer's *other* properties in years before the transfer. For each transfer of building i by owner j in year Y, we compute the mean filing rate (num_filings/total_units) across all other PIDs acquired by owner j, using only years strictly before Y. This avoids look-ahead bias — the classification uses no post-transfer data.

Acquirers are classified into four bins:

- **High-filer portfolio**: Above-median pre-acquisition filing rate (among those with positive rates and a portfolio)
- **Low-filer portfolio**: At or below median pre-acquisition filing rate
- **Non-filer (has portfolio)**: Zero filing rate but owns multiple properties
- **Single-purchase**: No other properties in the data (cannot compute a portfolio filing rate)

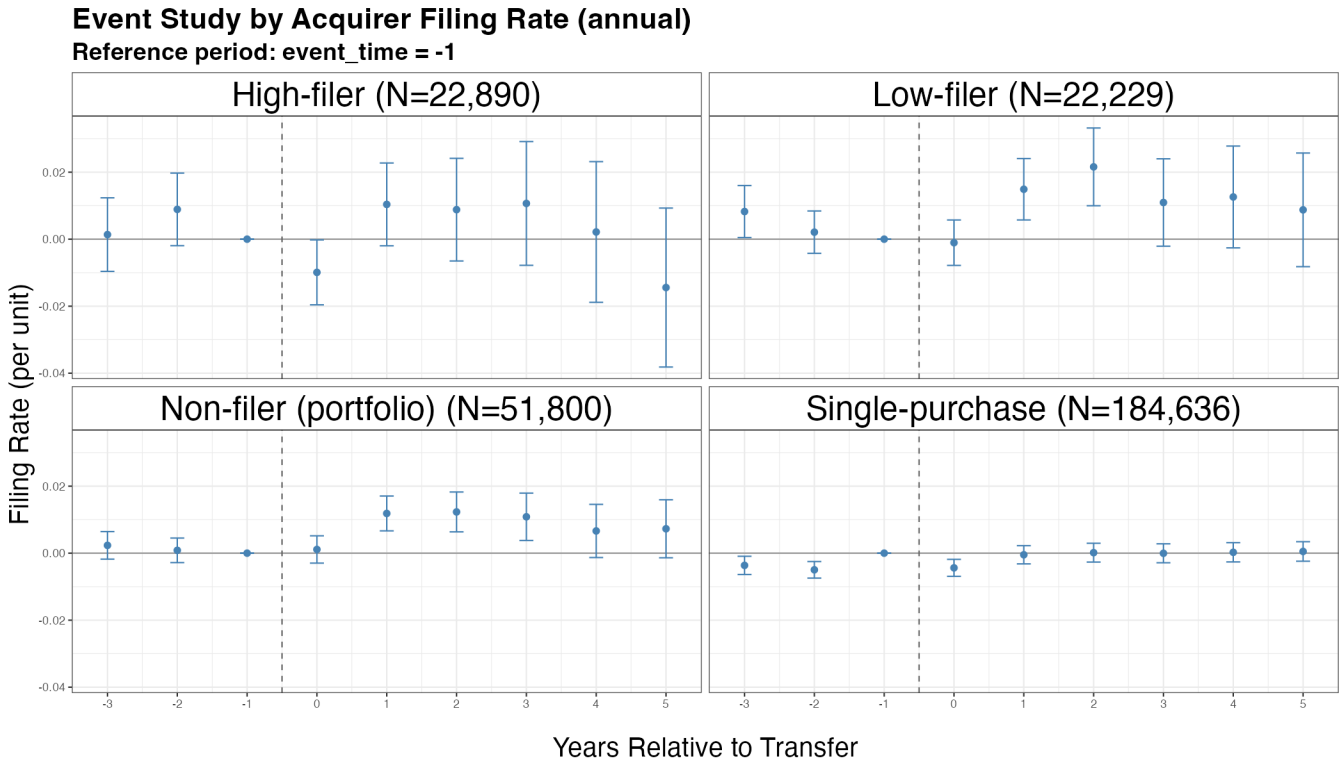

Figure 6: Event study by acquirer pre-acquisition filing rate. High-filer portfolio acquirers show the largest post-transfer increase.

	filing_rate			
Acquirer type	High-filer portfolio	Low-filer portfolio	Non-filer (has portfolio)	Single-purchase
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
event_time = -3	0.0014	0.0082**	0.0023	-0.0036***
	(0.0056)	(0.0040)	(0.0021)	(0.0014)
event_time = -2	0.0089	0.0021	0.0008	-0.0050***
	(0.0055)	(0.0032)	(0.0019)	(0.0013)
event_time = 0	-0.0099**	-0.0010	0.0011	-0.0044***
	(0.0049)	(0.0035)	(0.0021)	(0.0013)
event_time = 1	0.0104*	0.0149***	0.0119***	-0.0005
	(0.0063)	(0.0047)	(0.0027)	(0.0014)
event_time = 2	0.0088	0.0216***	0.0123***	0.0001
	(0.0078)	(0.0059)	(0.0030)	(0.0014)
event_time = 3	0.0107	0.0109	0.0109***	-3.95×10^{-5}
	(0.0094)	(0.0067)	(0.0036)	(0.0014)
event_time = 4	0.0021	0.0126	0.0066	0.0003
	(0.0107)	(0.0078)	(0.0040)	(0.0015)
event_time = 5	-0.0144	0.0088	0.0073*	0.0005
	(0.0121)	(0.0087)	(0.0044)	(0.0015)
Observations	22,890	22,229	51,800	184,636
R^2	0.40514	0.24587	0.25832	0.31733
Within R^2	0.00163	0.00199	0.00092	0.00022
PID fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓
year fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓

Table 6: Event study coefficients at key periods by acquirer pre-acquisition filing rate

Acquirer Type	t-2	t+1	t+3	t+5
full_highfiler_portfolio	0.0089	0.0104	0.0107	-0.0144
full_lowfiler_portfolio	0.0021	0.0149	0.0109	0.0088
full_nonfiler_has_portfolio	0.0008	0.0119	0.0109	0.0073
full_singlepurchase	-0.0050	-0.0005	0.0000	0.0005

The key findings:

- **High-filer portfolio** acquirers show the largest post-transfer increase in filing rates. These are serial acquirers whose pre-existing filing behavior on other properties predicts aggressive eviction filing on newly acquired buildings.
- **Low-filer portfolio** acquirers show a moderate increase, substantially smaller than high-filers.
- **Non-filer (has portfolio)** acquirers own multiple properties but had zero filing rates before this acquisition. They show little change post-transfer.
- **Single-purchase** acquirers (the majority) have no portfolio filing history. They show no meaningful post-transfer increase.

This decomposition — using only pre-acquisition behavior — confirms that the aggregate effect is driven by a specific subset of acquirers who are systematic high-filers. The classification is not

contaminated by post-transfer outcomes.

8 Heterogeneity by Building Size

We estimate the event study separately by building size bin (all 2+ units, pre-COVID only).

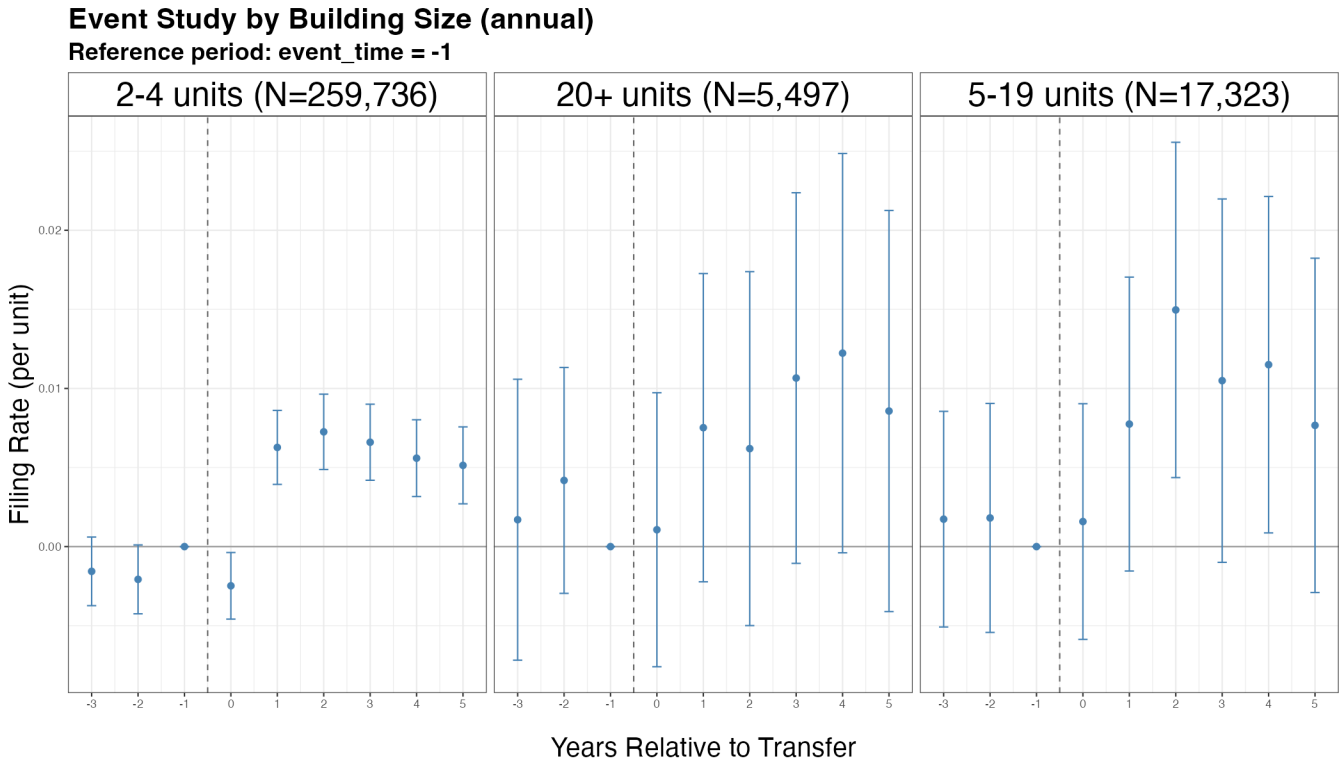

Figure 7: Event study by building size bin (2+ units). The effect appears across all size categories.

	filing_rate		
Building size	2-4 units	5-19 units	20+ units
	(1)	(2)	(3)
event_time = -3	-0.0016	0.0017	0.0017
	(0.0011)	(0.0035)	(0.0045)
event_time = -2	-0.0021*	0.0018	0.0042
	(0.0011)	(0.0037)	(0.0036)
event_time = 0	-0.0025**	0.0016	0.0011
	(0.0011)	(0.0038)	(0.0044)
event_time = 1	0.0063***	0.0077	0.0075
	(0.0012)	(0.0047)	(0.0050)
event_time = 2	0.0073***	0.0150***	0.0062
	(0.0012)	(0.0054)	(0.0057)
event_time = 3	0.0066***	0.0105*	0.0107*
	(0.0012)	(0.0059)	(0.0060)
event_time = 4	0.0056***	0.0115**	0.0122*
	(0.0012)	(0.0054)	(0.0064)
event_time = 5	0.0051***	0.0077	0.0086
	(0.0012)	(0.0054)	(0.0065)
Observations	259,736	17,323	5,497
R^2	0.26234	0.59950	0.66840
Within R^2	0.00069	0.00153	0.00193
PID fixed effects	✓	✓	✓
year fixed effects	✓	✓	✓

The post-transfer increase appears across all multi-family building sizes:

- **2–4 units**: Moderate post-transfer increase, flat pre-trends.
- **5–19 units**: Larger increase, relatively flat pre-trends.
- **20+ units**: Large increase, with a noisier pre-period given the smaller sample.

If anything, the effect is *larger* for bigger buildings, where each additional filing is a smaller share of units and thus harder to detect. We pool 5–19 units into a single bin given similar effect magnitudes and to improve statistical power.

8.1 Corporate buyer effect by building size

To confirm the corporate buyer effect isn't driven solely by small properties, we cross the buyer type and building size splits:

Table 7: Average post-transfer effect (t+1 to t+3) by buyer type and building size

Buyer type	Size bin	Mean coef (t+1 to t+3)	Mean SE
Corporate	2-4 units	0.0151	0.0027
Individual	2-4 units	0.0016	0.0014
Corporate	20+ units	0.0107	0.0066

Individual	20+ units	-0.0052	0.0062
Corporate	5-19 units	0.0167	0.0078
Individual	5-19 units	0.0002	0.0042

The corporate buyer effect is positive across all building sizes. Individual buyers show near-zero or negative effects in every size category.

9 Heterogeneity by Portfolio Size

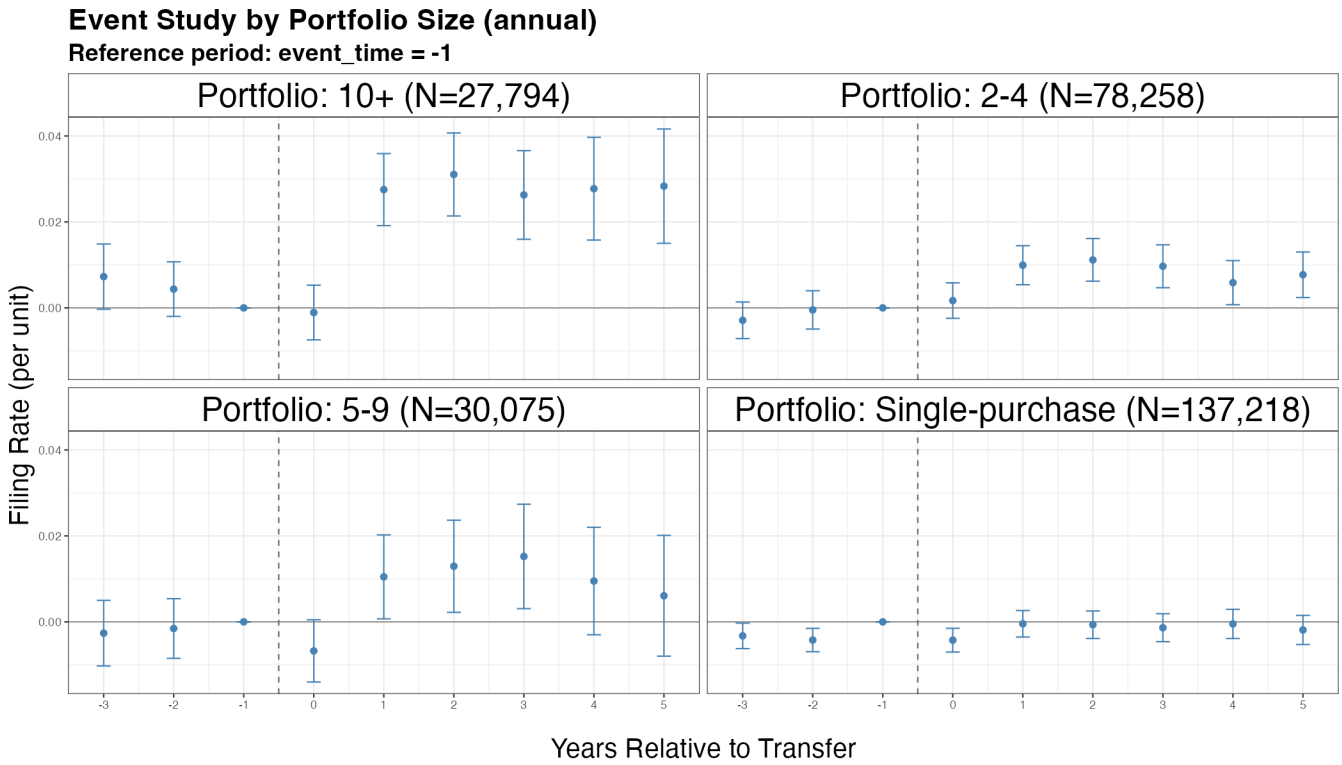

Figure 8: Event study by portfolio size (non-sheriff acquisitions).

Larger portfolio buyers (10+ non-sheriff properties) show the steepest post-transfer increase in filing rates. Single-purchase buyers show a more modest effect. The portfolio bin accounts for the total non-sheriff acquisitions by the buyer entity, so this captures whether serial acquirers are systematically more aggressive filers.

	filing_rate			
Portfolio size	Single-purchase	2-4	5-9	10+
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
event_time = -3	-0.0033**	-0.0029	-0.0026	0.0073*
	(0.0015)	(0.0022)	(0.0039)	(0.0039)
event_time = -2	-0.0042***	-0.0005	-0.0015	0.0044
	(0.0014)	(0.0023)	(0.0035)	(0.0032)
event_time = 0	-0.0043***	0.0017	-0.0068*	-0.0011
	(0.0014)	(0.0021)	(0.0037)	(0.0032)
event_time = 1	-0.0005	0.0099***	0.0105**	0.0275***
	(0.0016)	(0.0023)	(0.0050)	(0.0043)
event_time = 2	-0.0007	0.0112***	0.0129**	0.0310***
	(0.0016)	(0.0025)	(0.0055)	(0.0049)
event_time = 3	-0.0014	0.0097***	0.0152**	0.0263***
	(0.0017)	(0.0025)	(0.0062)	(0.0053)
event_time = 4	-0.0005	0.0059**	0.0095	0.0277***
	(0.0017)	(0.0026)	(0.0064)	(0.0061)
event_time = 5	-0.0019	0.0077***	0.0061	0.0283***
	(0.0017)	(0.0027)	(0.0072)	(0.0068)
Observations	137,218	78,258	30,075	27,794
R^2	0.31221	0.35897	0.32722	0.28017
Within R^2	0.00016	0.00083	0.00160	0.00391
PID fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓
year fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓

10 Robustness

All robustness checks use a **full-panel design**: the full building panel is merged with transfer timing, and explicit event-time dummies are constructed for $k \in \{-3, \dots, +5\}$ (omitting $k = -1$). Years outside the event window have all dummies set to zero, providing natural within-PID control periods. This approach avoids the problem of counting every observation as "treated" that would arise from a stacked event panel. All robustness specs restrict to 2+ unit buildings, pre-COVID (year $\leq$ 2019).

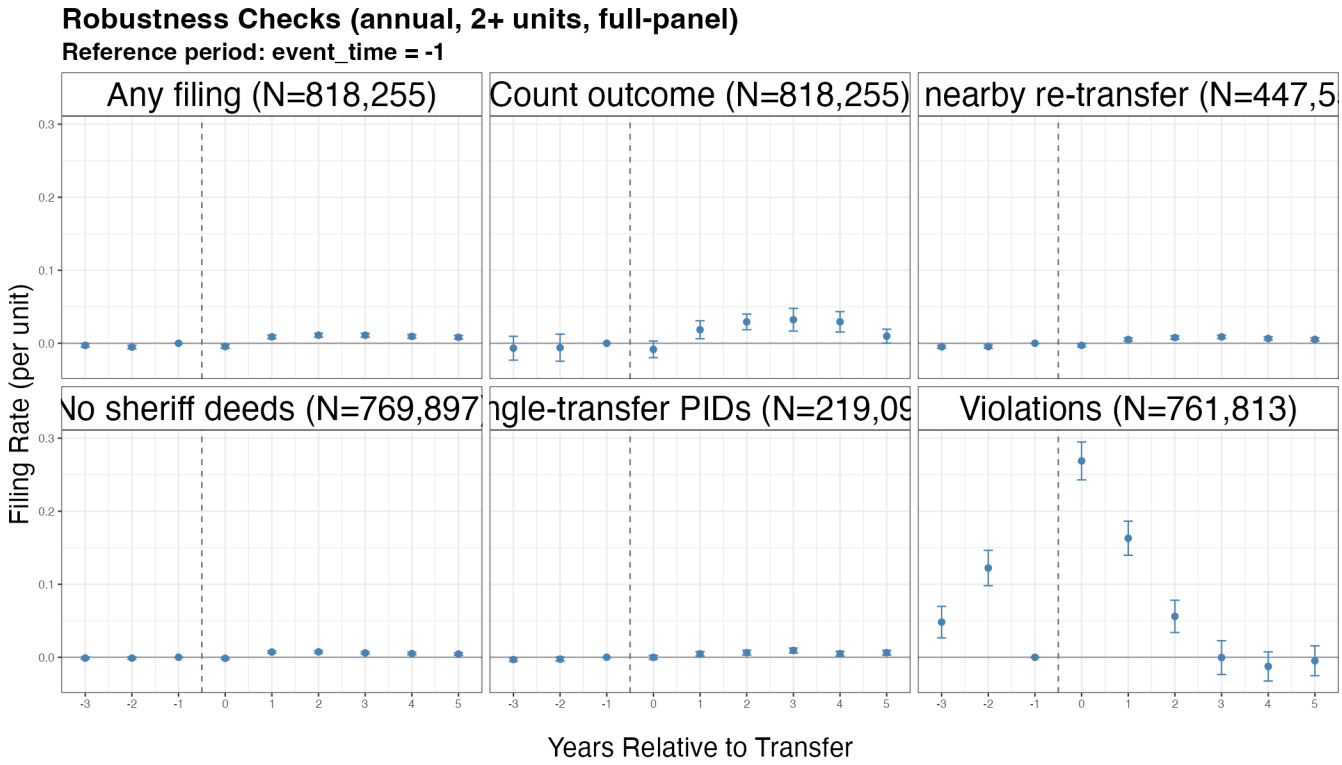

Figure 9: Robustness checks: alternative samples and outcomes (full-panel design, 2+ units, pre-COVID).

Robustness	No sheriff deeds (1)	filing_rate Single-transfer PIDs (2)	No nearby re-transfer (3)	num_filings Count outcome (4)	any_filing Any filing (5)	total_violations Violations (6)
et_m3	-0.0011	-0.0032**	-0.0049***	-0.0068	-0.0029**	0.0481***
	(0.0008)	(0.0012)	(0.0010)	(0.0083)	(0.0012)	(0.0110)
et_m2	-0.0012	-0.0025*	-0.0046***	-0.0060	-0.0053***	0.1222***
	(0.0008)	(0.0015)	(0.0011)	(0.0094)	(0.0012)	(0.0123)
et_0	-0.0014*	-0.0001	-0.0029***	-0.0084	-0.0045***	0.2689***
	(0.0008)	(0.0014)	(0.0010)	(0.0058)	(0.0013)	(0.0132)
et_1	0.0071***	0.0047***	0.0051***	0.0185***	0.0088***	0.1630***
	(0.0009)	(0.0016)	(0.0012)	(0.0063)	(0.0013)	(0.0119)
et_2	0.0073***	0.0063***	0.0078***	0.0293***	0.0110***	0.0560***
	(0.0009)	(0.0017)	(0.0012)	(0.0055)	(0.0014)	(0.0113)
et_3	0.0060***	0.0092***	0.0087***	0.0322***	0.0110***	-0.0004
	(0.0009)	(0.0017)	(0.0012)	(0.0079)	(0.0014)	(0.0118)
et_4	0.0050***	0.0049***	0.0065***	0.0294***	0.0094***	-0.0126
	(0.0008)	(0.0017)	(0.0012)	(0.0071)	(0.0013)	(0.0102)
et_5	0.0044***	0.0063***	0.0053***	0.0097**	0.0082***	-0.0048
	(0.0008)	(0.0017)	(0.0011)	(0.0049)	(0.0013)	(0.0104)
Observations	769,897	219,099	447,558	818,255	818,255	761,813
R^2	0.27685	0.36200	0.30022	0.65926	0.28616	0.20130
Within R^2	0.00033	0.00042	0.00051	8.11×10^{-5}	0.00038	0.00119
PID fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
year fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

10.1 No sheriff's deeds

Sheriff's deed transfers are foreclosures, where the "buyer" is typically a bank or GSE (Fannie Mae, Freddie Mac) that temporarily holds title. These entities do not operate as landlords and are unlikely to file evictions. Excluding sheriff's deeds removes approximately 10% of transfers.

10.2 Single-transfer PIDs

The baseline allows overlapping event windows for PIDs with multiple transfers. As a robustness check, we restrict to PIDs with only one transfer during the sample period.

10.3 No nearby re-transfer

We exclude transfers where the same PID has another transfer within 2 years, avoiding contamination from overlapping ownership spells.

10.4 Count outcome

Using the raw count of eviction filings (`num_filings`) instead of the rate (per unit) confirms the direction of the effect. This addresses the concern that rate-based measures might be sensitive to changes in `total_units` around transfers.

10.5 Any-filing indicator

A binary indicator for whether any eviction filings occurred in a given year tests whether the effect operates on the extensive margin (more buildings filing) rather than only the intensive margin (more filings per building).

10.6 Violations outcome

Building code violations are examined as a secondary outcome. **Note:** Philadelphia L&I violations data begins in 2007, so the violations regressions are additionally restricted to calendar years $\geq$ 2007 to avoid spurious zeros in the pre-period.

Figure 10: Violations around transfer by buyer type (year $\geq$ 2007, 2+ units, full-panel design).

11 Pooled Window Estimates

We pool event-time periods into four windows to summarize the magnitude and significance of the transfer effect:

- **Pre** ($t \in \{-3, -2\}$): Baseline period before transfer
- **Transition** ($t \in \{-1, 0\}$): Transfer year and immediate lead
- **Early post** ($t \in \{1, 2\}$): First two post-transfer years
- **Late post** ($t \in \{3, 4, 5\}$): Three to five years after transfer

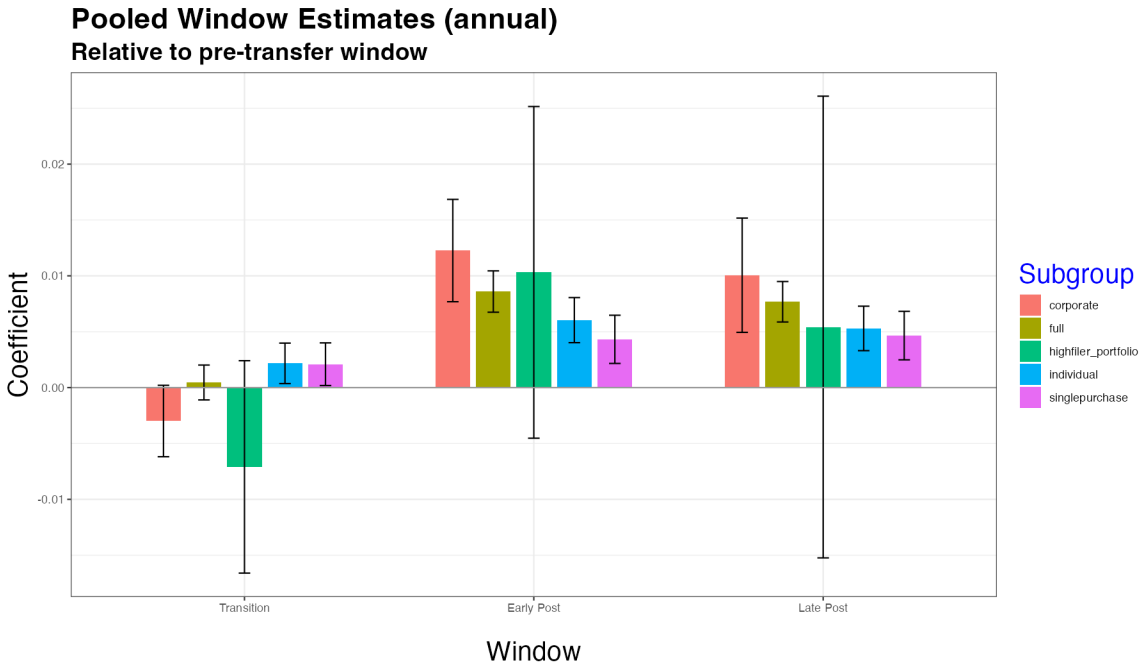

Figure 11: Pooled window estimates: filing rate change relative to pre-transfer period.

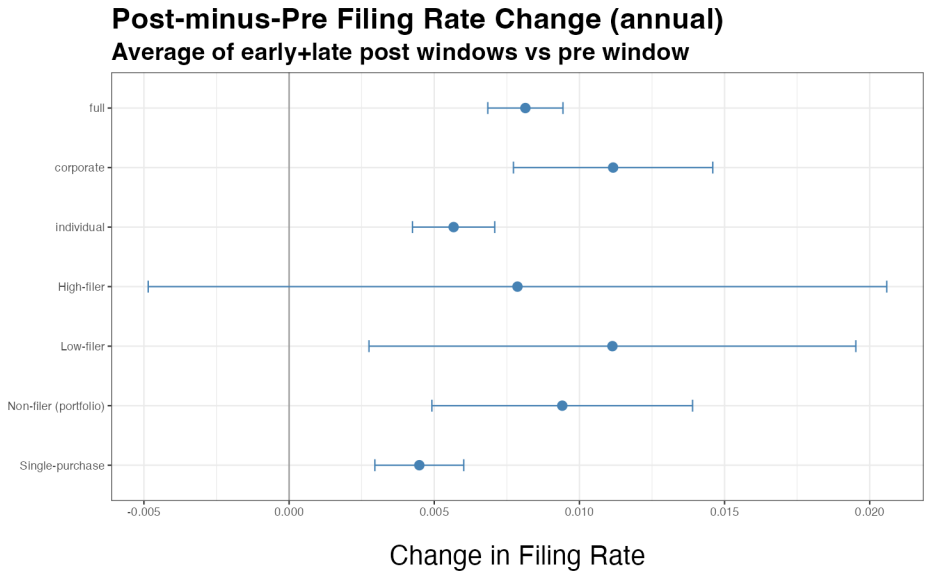

Figure 12: Post-minus-pre filing rate change by subgroup. Average of early and late post windows, relative to pre-transfer.

Table 8: Post-minus-pre filing rate change by subgroup

Subgroup	Post-Pre	SE	CI Lower	CI Upper	N
full	0.00814	0.00066	0.00685	0.00943	282,576
corporate	0.01116	0.00175	0.00773	0.01459	95,596

individual	0.00567	0.00072	0.00425	0.00708	186,097
highfiler_portfolio	0.00787	0.00649	-0.00485	0.02059	22,890
lowfiler_portfolio	0.01114	0.00428	0.00275	0.01952	22,229
nonfiler_has_portfolio	0.00941	0.00229	0.00492	0.01390	51,800
singlepurchase	0.00449	0.00078	0.00296	0.00602	184,636

12 Composition Diagnostics

Table 9: Sample composition by event time (pre-COVID)

Event Time	N obs	N PIDs	% Units Obs	Mean Units	% Pre-Rental	% Post-Only Rental	% Corpor
-3	598,088	340,353	26.2	1.5	11.3	21.9	2
-2	570,618	329,936	27.1	1.5	10.8	22.2	2
-1	539,332	318,798	28.8	1.5	10.2	22.6	2
0	513,359	309,367	31.6	1.5	9.7	22.9	2
1	482,553	296,408	35.0	1.5	9.0	23.1	2
2	450,505	282,020	38.1	1.5	8.4	23.1	1
3	418,919	267,926	40.8	1.5	7.6	23.1	1
4	389,896	254,719	43.5	1.5	6.8	23.1	1
5	366,178	243,393	46.0	1.5	6.1	23.0	1

This table verifies that sample composition does not change dramatically across event time, which would confound the event study estimates.

13 Appendix: Data Pipeline

Scripts:

1. `r/build-owner-linkage.R` — Owner name standardization, entity grouping, portfolio construction
2. `r/analyze-transfer-evictions-unified.R` — Event panel construction and all regressions (supports annual and quarterly frequency via config)

Key data products:

Product	Key	Description
`owner_linkage_xwalk.csv`	`grantee_upper`	Maps raw grantee names to standardized `owner_std` and `owner_group_id`
`owner_portfolio.csv`	`owner_group_id`	Portfolio sizes, acquisition years, sheriff deed counts

Config keys added: `owner_linkage_xwalk`, `owner_portfolio` (under `products:` in `config.yml`).

Rental license coverage note: Philadelphia's Open Data business license records begin substantive rental license coverage around 2013. All rental market entry regressions are restricted to year $\geq$ 2011. Altos (Apartments.com) listing data begins in 2006.